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Higher education needs reforms. As soon as Class XII exams are over, students have to run from one university to another and from one state to another for the Common Entrance Test (CET) for admission to engineering, management or medical colleges. We have to take a stand on this—have a uniform CET across the country. The other issue is that of the Medical Council of India (MCI). The MCI has to change itself in the days to come as the students may not want to

become doctors because eight years is a long period. If you want doctors to reach out to the villages, we should have a short course, say of three years of basic diagnostic medicine and treatment and then have a specialty course of five years followed by a super-specialty course. ”

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moves from higher into secondary education, he realises that Hindi is a necessary language for him. I have taken the example of states which don't teach in Hindi. Now what happens is that he realises that he needs to understand Hindi because if he wants to integrate with the rest of the country, Hindi is an important language. In many of these states, Hindi is not a strong point and Hindi is not taught with the same fervour with which the mother tongue is taught. But Hindi integrates you with the rest of the nation. And as that child moves into the university system, he realises that he can't get a job without having a good command over English. But because he has been taught in his mother tongue and in Hindi, when he moves into the university system, though he is bright and is a repository of knowledge, yet he cannot succeed because he cannot communicate effectively. Communication of all knowledge in higher education is in English. All your technical, engineering and even the medical textbooks are in English. And so, he finds himself at a loss. He, therefore, cannot compete, and the result is that you have elitist children, who studied in English-medium schools and who walk away with all the jobs. This is a national problem. How do we solve it? We need to come together and we need to collectively put our minds together. India cannot wait for solutions. We must find those solutions here and now.

